

2026 Local Business & Industry Needs Assessment

Centennial High School

<https://forms.cloud.microsoft/r/d04CqZvUNU>

1. Business/Organization Name

Business Name: _____

2. Industry Category

A. Information Technology

B. Software Development

C. Cybersecurity

D. Banking / Financial Services

E. Financial Technology (FinTech)

F. Accounting

G. Business Services

H. Healthcare

I. Engineering

J. Manufacturing

K. Government

L. Retail

M. Education

N. Other: _____

3. Your Position

A. Owner / President

B. Executive Leadership

C. Manager

- D. Supervisor
- E. Human Resources
- F. Technical Professional
- G. Teacher / Educator
- H. Other: _____

4. Approximate Company Size

- A. 1-10 Employees
- B. 11-50 Employees
- C. 51-250 Employees
- D. 251-1000 Employees
- E. 1000+ Employees

5. Which entry-level positions does your organization hire most often? (Select all that apply)

- A. Administrative Support
- B. Customer Service
- C. Business Operations
- D. Sales
- E. Marketing
- F. Accounting / Finance
- G. IT Support
- H. Software Development
- I. Cybersecurity
- J. Data Analytics
- K. Engineering

L. Other

6. Preferred education level for entry-level employees

A. High School Diploma

B. Technical Certificate

C. Associate Degree

D. Bachelor's Degree

E. Depends on Position

7. Do industry certifications improve a candidate's employment opportunities in your organization?

A. Yes

B. No

C. Sometimes

8. Which technical skills are most valuable for new employees? (Select all that apply)

A. Microsoft Office / Microsoft 365

B. Excel

C. Business Communication Technology

D. Accounting Software

E. Financial Analysis

F. Data Analytics

G. Programming / Coding

H. Cybersecurity Awareness

I. Networking

J. AI Tools (Copilot, ChatGPT, etc.)

K. Cloud Computing

L. Digital Marketing

9. Which technologies do you believe will grow in importance during the next 5 years?
(Select all that apply)

A. Artificial Intelligence (AI)

B. Cybersecurity

C. Data Analytics

D. Cloud Computing

E. Financial Technology (FinTech)

F. Software Development

G. Digital Business Operations

H. Internet of Things (IoT)

I. Automation / Robotics

10. Please indicate your level of support for each program area.

Introduction to Business & Technology

Financial Services

Financial Technology (FinTech)

Computer Science

Software Development

Cybersecurity

Data Analytics

Artificial Intelligence

Scale: Strongly Support, Support, Neutral, Do Not Support

11. Select the FIVE most important soft skills for new employees. (Select up to five)

- A. Communication
- B. Professionalism
- C. Reliability
- D. Teamwork
- E. Problem Solving
- F. Critical Thinking
- G. Adaptability
- H. Time Management
- I. Leadership
- J. Customer Service
- K. Initiative
- L. Creativity

12. Which area needs the most improvement among recent graduates entering the workforce?

- A. Communication Skills
- B. Professionalism
- C. Technical Skills
- D. Time Management
- E. Problem Solving
- F. Teamwork
- G. Work Ethic

13. Which partnership opportunities would your organization be willing to support? (Select all that apply)

- A. Guest Speaker

- B. Career Fair Participation
- C. Advisory Committee Membership
- D. Mock Interviews
- E. Job Shadowing
- F. Internships
- G. Work-Based Learning Placements
- H. FBLA Competition Judge
- I. Classroom Project Mentor

14. Would your organization consider hiring a qualified Centennial High School CTAE student or graduate?

- A. Yes
- B. No
- C. Maybe

15. Which THREE areas should Centennial High School prioritize over the next five years?
(Select up to three)

- Business Education
- Entrepreneurship
- Financial Literacy
- Financial Services
- Financial Technology (FinTech)
- Artificial Intelligence
- Cybersecurity
- Software Development
- Computer Science
- Data Analytics

Work-Based Learning

Career Certifications